

Aryan antiquity, and did not lay enough stress on it to give us any expansion of the idea. Whether this be so or not, he seems to have created terms of his own which were more in accord with his trend of thought.¹ He likes to dwell on the word “*best*” (*vahišta*), which ultimately survived all other names for heaven: it may be read in the new Manichæan fragments from Turfan, and in Modern Persian still. The name of the Amshaspand *Vohū* or *Vahištām Manō* describes the paradise where the Best Thought dwells.² It seems fair to claim that Zarathushtra anticipated Marlowe and Milton in the great doctrine that

The mind is its own place, and in itself
Can make a heaven of hell, a hell of heaven.

Sometimes we find “the House of Good Thought” (*Ys* 30¹⁰ *al.*), “the Kingdom of Good Thought” (*Ys* 33⁶), “the Kingdom of blessings” (*Ys* 28⁹), “the Pasture of Good Thought” (*Ys* 33³), “the glorious heritage of Good Thought” (*Ys* 53⁴); and we are told in a fine sentence that the way to it is on “the road of Good Thought, built by Right, on which the Selves of the Future Deliverers shall go to the reward” (*Ys* 34¹³). The language used is not quite free from metaphor. The poet longs to “see

¹ Söderblom, following Darmesteter, would add one to the list which I do not venture to give except in a footnote. In *Ys* 46¹⁶, *varədamqm* was read by the Pahlavi glossator as a compound of *varə* and *dəma*; and Darmesteter rendered duly “Dans la demeure des vœux comblés.” Bartholomae (*Idg. Forsch.*, x. 10) says the Pahlavi is only an “etymologische Spielerei,” which the French savant has taken *au grand sérieux*. He himself makes it an infinitive (Skt *vardhman*): Geldner renders “in seiner Herrlichkeit.” I confess I rather like the *Spielerei*, and sympathise with Söderblom. See *La Vie Future*, 99, and my note on *Ys* 46 *l.c.*

² See below, p. 349, note on *Ys* 30⁴.